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Sudoku Sampler

Easy to Expert: 18 Puzzles in Four Levels

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Sudoku Sampler

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How to solve Sudoku

Fill every empty square with a digit so that each row, each column and each outlined box contains every digit exactly once.

A 9×9 grid uses the digits 1 to 9 in 3×3 boxes. A 6×6 grid uses 1 to 6 in boxes of 2 rows by 3 columns, and a 4×4 grid uses 1 to 4 in 2×2 boxes.

Every puzzle has exactly one solution. Easy and Medium puzzles need only two ideas: a square where just one digit fits, or a digit that fits in just one square of a row, column or box.

Hard puzzles also need pencil marks: write the possible digits small in each square and look for pairs and for digits locked into one row or column of a box. Expert puzzles go further still.

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Easy

Puzzles 1–6

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Puzzle 1

Easy

3					6	4		7
1	2	7	4	9	8		5	
6				3		2		
	8							5
	3		5	6	4		2	
9							7	
		9		4				3
	4		6	7	9	5	1	2
2		6	3					9

Puzzle 2

Easy

	5	8	7	2	1			6
3			6				5	
6	1			8		4	2	
		4	5			3		
5								9
		1			8	7		
	6	2		5			8	4
	9				4			3
1			8	7	6	5	9	

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Puzzle 3

Easy

			7		6			
	1	3	2	9	8	7		
6			5				2	9
		7			2			6
	6	9	4	7	1	3	5	
8			6			2		
1	4				7			3
		5	1	6	3	4	8	
			9		5			

Puzzle 4

Easy

8					2		5	
6		4	7			8		2
1	5		8			4	3	
		1		2			8	3
3			1		4			5
7	6			8		2		
	8	9			1		7	4
4		6			7	5		8
	7		5					6

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Puzzle 5

Easy

	8	4	3		7			
1			8			6		
	9	7	2		1	8		
	2		5	9		1		
5			7	1	2			8
		1		8	3		2	
		5	4		8	2	1	
		2			6			9
			9		5	3	8	

Puzzle 6

Easy

		1	3	5		7	9	
			4				8	6
9						5		
	2		7		6	9		5
7	6		9		5		1	8
5		4	8		1		3	
		9						1
4	3				9			
	1	5		6	3	4		

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Medium

Puzzles 7–10

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Puzzle 7

Medium

2	9	8	1		3		6	7
	1	3		8				
			7					8
		2		4				
5			2		1			3
				3		2		
1					7			
				6		9	5	
4	6		9		8	7	3	2

Puzzle 8

Medium

			3			6		
		4	9		2			
6	3				5	7		9
7		3	1		8			
	4			5			7	
			2		4	3		1
3		9	8				5	7
			5		9	2		
		2			1			

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Puzzle 9

Medium

	4				7		6	9
9			4			3		5
3		6	1		5			
4	5	2					7	
	6					2	4	3
			6		2	4		7
1		4			3			2
6	2		7				5	

Puzzle 10

Medium

		6	5			7	9	2
	9							
4	7		8	1		6		
					6		1	8
		4	7		1	5		
6	1		2					
		8		2	7		6	9
							3	
2	6	9			5	8		

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Hard

Puzzles 11–14

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Puzzle 11

Hard

5						6		3
	7				9	4		
	9					1		
			1	8		7	4	
4			6		7			5
	1	5		3	4			
		6					3	
		8	2				7	
9		7						2

Puzzle 12

Hard

		1	2	8			6	
	2			9		7		
								1
5				3	9	2		
	9		4		2		7	
		2	7	1				9
6								
		8		6			9	
	4			7	5	1		

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Puzzle 13

Hard

			2				8	
			5	6	7	4		
		1					5	
		5		7		8	4	
	1						6	
	7	9		8		1		
	5					2		
		3	9	4	5			
	6				1			

Puzzle 14

Hard

				6	7			
8					4	3		
				1			9	8
		8	1					7
1		7		5		2		6
9					8	1		
6	2			7				
		1	6					2
			4	8				

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Expert

Puzzles 15–18

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Puzzle 15

Expert

			2			8		
4	3	9			8			
8		7	1	9				
		3					6	
		4	8	7	1	5		
	7					9		
				8	9	4		7
			3			2	8	5
		8			5			

Puzzle 16

Expert

1							2	
		9	3	1	5		4	6
		6						
				3	4		7	
		4	7		8	2		
	7		1	5				
						9		
4	1		2	6	9	3		
	9							5

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Puzzle 17

Expert

	5				2	9		
		3	7			5		8
	1			9				7
6			5			3	7	9
9	3	7			6			5
3				4			5	
5		1			9	8		
		8	3				9	

Puzzle 18

Expert

		4	6					2
	3			4			8	
6	1		7			4		
				2			6	
		3	1		6	9		
	7			9				
		9			3		4	1
	4			1			2	
7					4	5		

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Answers: Easy

1

3	5	8	1	2	**6**	**4**	9	**7**
1	**2**	**7**	**4**	**9**	**8**	3	**5**	6
6	9	4	7	**3**	5	**2**	8	1
4	**8**	2	9	1	7	6	3	**5**
7	**3**	1	**5**	**6**	**4**	9	**2**	8
9	6	5	2	8	3	1	**7**	4
5	1	**9**	8	**4**	2	7	6	**3**
8	**4**	3	**6**	**7**	**9**	**5**	**1**	**2**
2	7	**6**	**3**	5	1	8	4	**9**

2

4	**5**	**8**	**7**	**2**	**1**	9	3	**6**
3	2	7	**6**	4	9	8	**5**	1
6	**1**	9	3	**8**	5	**4**	**2**	7
9	7	**4**	**5**	6	2	**3**	1	8
5	8	6	1	3	7	2	4	**9**
2	3	**1**	4	9	**8**	**7**	6	5
7	**6**	**2**	9	**5**	3	1	**8**	**4**
8	**9**	5	2	1	**4**	6	7	**3**
1	4	3	**8**	**7**	**6**	**5**	**9**	2

3

9	2	4	**7**	1	**6**	8	3	5
5	**1**	**3**	**2**	**9**	**8**	**7**	6	4
6	7	8	**5**	3	4	1	**2**	**9**
4	5	**7**	3	8	**2**	9	1	**6**
2	**6**	**9**	**4**	**7**	**1**	**3**	**5**	8
8	3	1	**6**	5	9	**2**	4	7
1	**4**	6	8	2	**7**	5	9	**3**
7	9	**5**	**1**	**6**	**3**	**4**	**8**	2
3	8	2	**9**	4	**5**	6	7	1

4

8	3	7	4	1	**2**	6	**5**	9
6	9	**4**	**7**	5	3	**8**	1	**2**
1	**5**	2	**8**	9	6	**4**	**3**	7
9	4	**1**	6	**2**	5	7	**8**	**3**
3	2	8	**1**	7	**4**	9	6	**5**
7	**6**	5	3	**8**	9	**2**	4	1
5	**8**	**9**	2	6	**1**	3	**7**	**4**
4	1	**6**	9	3	**7**	**5**	2	**8**
2	**7**	3	**5**	4	8	1	9	**6**

5

2	**8**	**4**	**3**	6	**7**	5	9	1
1	5	3	**8**	4	9	**6**	7	2
6	**9**	**7**	**2**	5	**1**	**8**	4	3
3	**2**	8	**5**	**9**	4	**1**	6	7
5	6	9	**7**	**1**	**2**	4	3	**8**
4	7	**1**	6	**8**	**3**	9	**2**	5
9	3	**5**	**4**	7	**8**	**2**	**1**	6
8	4	**2**	1	3	**6**	7	5	**9**
7	1	6	**9**	2	**5**	**3**	**8**	4

6

6	8	**1**	**3**	**5**	2	**7**	**9**	4
3	5	2	**4**	9	7	1	**8**	**6**
9	4	7	6	1	8	**5**	2	3
1	**2**	8	**7**	3	**6**	**9**	4	**5**
7	**6**	3	**9**	4	**5**	2	**1**	**8**
5	9	**4**	**8**	2	**1**	6	**3**	7
2	7	**9**	5	8	4	3	6	**1**
4	**3**	6	1	7	**9**	8	5	2
8	**1**	**5**	2	**6**	**3**	**4**	7	9

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Answers: Medium

7

2	**9**	**8**	**1**	5	**3**	4	**6**	**7**
7	**1**	**3**	4	**8**	6	5	2	9
6	5	4	**7**	9	2	3	1	**8**
3	8	**2**	6	**4**	9	1	7	5
5	4	6	**2**	7	**1**	8	9	**3**
9	7	1	8	**3**	5	**2**	4	6
1	3	9	5	2	**7**	6	8	4
8	2	7	3	**6**	4	**9**	**5**	1
4	**6**	5	**9**	1	**8**	**7**	**3**	**2**

8

2	9	5	**3**	1	7	**6**	4	8
8	7	**4**	**9**	6	**2**	1	3	5
6	**3**	1	4	8	**5**	**7**	2	**9**
7	2	**3**	**1**	9	**8**	5	6	4
1	**4**	8	6	**5**	3	9	**7**	2
9	5	6	**2**	7	**4**	**3**	8	**1**
3	1	**9**	**8**	2	6	4	**5**	**7**
4	8	7	**5**	3	**9**	**2**	1	6
5	6	**2**	7	4	**1**	8	9	3

9

2	**4**	5	8	3	**7**	1	**6**	**9**
9	1	7	**4**	2	6	**3**	8	**5**
3	8	**6**	**1**	9	**5**	7	2	4
4	**5**	**2**	3	6	1	9	**7**	8
8	3	9	2	7	4	5	1	6
7	**6**	1	9	5	8	**2**	**4**	**3**
5	9	8	**6**	1	**2**	**4**	3	**7**
1	7	**4**	5	8	**3**	6	9	**2**
6	**2**	3	**7**	4	9	8	**5**	1

10

1	8	**6**	**5**	3	4	**7**	**9**	**2**
5	**9**	3	6	7	2	1	8	4
4	**7**	2	**8**	**1**	9	**6**	5	3
9	2	7	4	5	**6**	3	**1**	**8**
8	3	**4**	**7**	9	**1**	**5**	2	6
6	**1**	5	**2**	8	3	9	4	7
3	5	**8**	1	**2**	**7**	4	**6**	**9**
7	4	1	9	6	8	2	**3**	5
2	**6**	**9**	3	4	**5**	**8**	7	1

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Answers: Hard

11

5	2	4	8	7	1	**6**	9	**3**
6	**7**	1	3	5	**9**	**4**	2	8
8	**9**	3	4	6	2	**1**	5	7
3	6	2	**1**	**8**	5	**7**	**4**	9
4	8	9	**6**	2	**7**	3	1	**5**
7	**1**	**5**	9	**3**	**4**	2	8	6
2	5	**6**	7	4	8	9	**3**	1
1	3	**8**	**2**	9	6	5	**7**	4
9	4	**7**	5	1	3	8	6	**2**

12

9	5	**1**	**2**	**8**	7	4	**6**	3
3	**2**	4	1	**9**	6	**7**	8	5
8	7	6	5	4	3	9	2	**1**
5	8	7	6	**3**	**9**	**2**	1	4
1	**9**	3	**4**	5	**2**	6	**7**	8
4	6	**2**	**7**	**1**	8	3	5	**9**
6	3	5	9	2	1	8	4	7
7	1	**8**	3	**6**	4	5	**9**	2
2	**4**	9	8	**7**	**5**	**1**	3	6

13

5	4	6	**2**	1	3	9	**8**	7
3	9	8	**5**	**6**	**7**	**4**	1	2
7	2	**1**	8	9	4	3	**5**	6
6	3	**5**	1	**7**	2	**8**	**4**	9
8	**1**	2	4	5	9	7	**6**	3
4	**7**	**9**	3	**8**	6	**1**	2	5
1	**5**	7	6	3	8	**2**	9	4
2	8	**3**	**9**	**4**	**5**	6	7	1
9	**6**	4	7	2	**1**	5	3	8

14

3	1	9	8	**6**	**7**	5	2	4
8	7	5	2	9	**4**	**3**	6	1
4	6	2	3	**1**	5	7	**9**	**8**
2	3	**8**	**1**	4	6	9	5	**7**
1	4	**7**	9	**5**	3	**2**	8	**6**
9	5	6	7	2	**8**	**1**	4	3
6	**2**	4	5	**7**	1	8	3	9
5	8	**1**	**6**	3	9	4	7	**2**
7	9	3	**4**	**8**	2	6	1	5

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Answers: Expert

15

1	6	5	**2**	3	4	**8**	7	9
4	**3**	**9**	7	5	**8**	1	2	6
8	2	**7**	**1**	**9**	6	3	5	4
5	8	**3**	9	4	2	7	**6**	1
6	9	**4**	**8**	**7**	**1**	**5**	3	2
2	**7**	1	5	6	3	**9**	4	8
3	5	2	6	**8**	**9**	**4**	1	**7**
9	4	6	**3**	1	7	**2**	**8**	**5**
7	1	**8**	4	2	**5**	6	9	3

16

1	4	7	9	8	6	5	**2**	3
8	2	**9**	**3**	**1**	**5**	7	**4**	**6**
5	3	**6**	4	2	7	1	9	8
2	5	1	6	**3**	**4**	8	**7**	9
3	6	**4**	**7**	9	**8**	**2**	5	1
9	**7**	8	**1**	**5**	2	6	3	4
7	8	3	5	4	1	**9**	6	2
4	**1**	5	**2**	**6**	**9**	**3**	8	7
6	**9**	2	8	7	3	4	1	**5**

17

7	**5**	6	8	3	**2**	**9**	1	4
2	9	**3**	**7**	1	4	**5**	6	**8**
8	**1**	4	6	**9**	5	2	3	**7**
6	4	2	**5**	8	1	**3**	**7**	**9**
1	8	5	9	7	3	4	2	6
9	**3**	**7**	4	2	**6**	1	8	**5**
3	6	9	1	**4**	8	7	**5**	2
5	7	**1**	2	6	**9**	**8**	4	3
4	2	**8**	**3**	5	7	6	**9**	1

18

8	5	**4**	**6**	3	1	7	9	**2**
9	**3**	7	5	**4**	2	1	**8**	6
6	**1**	2	**7**	8	9	**4**	5	3
1	9	5	4	**2**	7	3	**6**	8
2	8	**3**	**1**	5	**6**	**9**	7	4
4	**7**	6	3	**9**	8	2	1	5
5	6	**9**	2	7	**3**	8	**4**	**1**
3	**4**	8	9	**1**	5	6	**2**	7
7	2	1	8	6	**4**	**5**	3	9

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